

Game launch

Starcraft II closed beta to be launched soon by
Blizzard Entertainment

Alan Wake

The game is not expected to hit PCs; Xbox360
exclusive only

Bazaar

Creative Zen X Fi 2

Great sound with disappointing touchscreen

Zen X Fi 2 is Creative's first touch screen MP3 player. Its design resembles the Apple iPod touch, with a grey matte finish on the rear and a 3-inch display screen. The player is light and has a good grip. It has a micro SD card slot on the top that can increase the memory, an audio jack and a micro USB port on the right hand side. With the square button next to the screen, you can go to the home menu. A power button is attached to the chassis and does not jut out.

Zen X Fi2 has a simple user interface showing menus such as music, video, radio, photos among others that make the navigational task very easy. It



supports MP3, WMA, WAV, AAC and FLAC. The sound quality is good; the Expand EQ option gives 3D surround sound effect, thus bringing to life flat music.

While playing videos, you don't need compression while transferring video files to the player. It has a good 5 hours of video playback.

However, the resistive touch screen was disappointing. The sluggish response is a nightmare. Moreover, there are no external volume control buttons making it extremely clumsy to adjust volume or change tracks when the player is in your pocket.

At Rs. 8,999 we feel this is too high a price for a product with glaring flaws.

Specifications

Display Resolution: 240 x 400 pixels, Memory: 8 GB, Battery: Lithium Ion, Battery life: 26 hours (audio), FM radio

Contact

Creative Technology

Web site: www.in.

creative.com

Price: Rs. 8,999

5.5
10

Features.....7
Performance 6.5
Build Quality4
Value4

Specifications

Inputs - iPod / iPhone,
3.5mm audio connects, USB
(for firmware upgrade)
Dimensions: 221 x 432 x
244 mm, weight: 8.4 kg

Contact

Bose India

Phone: 1-800-11-2673

Email: pr@boseindia.com

Web site: www.

boseindia.com

Price: Rs. 40,388

6.5
10

Features.....7
Performance7
Build Quality8
Value3

Bose SoundDock 10

Expensive iPod companion

Bose has extended their exotic offerings into accessories for Apple's iPod as well. The SoundDock 10 is one of their newer releases that sports a pricey Rs. 40,000 price tag.

The design is sturdy, but what's noticeable is the weight. It's 8.4 kg that makes it one of the heavier docks around. The connects are straight forward - a dock for the iPod and a 3.5-mm jack to connect a PC, PMP or any other device to it.

The device performs rather well for its size, but it is by no means a replacement for proper desktop speakers. Separation

of audio channels is one of the first problems. There is some distortion with the volume set to high. A larger room improves the performance a bit. Although you can't expect a whole lot from small iPod docks, this one is pretty good for a decent sized room. The remote has few buttons and is simple to use; range is pretty decent as well.

Overall, it's a very sensible purchase only if you can afford it. For most people, a 3.5-mm



connection to a very good desktop setup would be better. 8.5 kg is too much to even call it portable. However, it is a good solution for iPod users who want something that fits well into a medium-sized living room or bedroom. It even makes using the iPod simpler.